

9 Nimrod

"A mighty hunter before the LORD," the first empire-builder in Scripture.

Nimrod appears in the Table of Nations, the list of Noah's descendants in Genesis 10. He was a great-grandson of Noah through Ham and Cush. Genesis calls him the first "mighty one in the earth" and "a mighty hunter before the LORD," a phrase that became a proverb. He founded a kingdom in Shinar, the land of Babylon, including the city of Babel. Scripture gives him only a few verses and never describes his character directly. Later tradition made him the builder of the tower of Babel, but Genesis does not say so. His story marks a new stage after the flood: the rise of cities, kingdoms and human power.

At a glance

Name	Hebrew <i>Nimrod</i> . Its meaning is uncertain
Family	Son of Cush; grandson of Ham; great-grandson of Noah (Genesis 10:1, 6, 8)
Known as	"A mighty one in the earth" and "a mighty hunter before the LORD" (Genesis 10:8–9)
Kingdom	Babel, Erech, Accad and Calneh, in the land of Shinar (Genesis 10:10)
Main passages	Genesis 10:8–12; 1 Chronicles 1:10
Later reference	"The land of Nimrod," meaning Assyria (Micah 5:6)
New Testament	Not named

*"He was a mighty hunter before the LORD: wherefore it is said,
Even as Nimrod the mighty hunter before the LORD."*

Genesis 10:9, KJV

The life of Nimrod

Genesis gives no dates or ages for Nimrod. The order below follows the text. Scholars have tried to match him with various ancient kings, but no match is certain.

After the flood	● Born to Cush Cush, son of Ham, fathers Nimrod. <i>Genesis 10:6-8</i>
Grown	● Becomes a mighty one "He began to be a mighty one in the earth." <i>Genesis 10:8</i>
Known far and wide	● A mighty hunter His skill as a hunter becomes a saying: "Even as Nimrod the mighty hunter before the LORD." <i>Genesis 10:9</i>
In Shinar	● Founds a kingdom His kingdom begins with Babel, Erech, Accad and Calneh in Shinar. <i>Genesis 10:10</i>
Later	● Expands north Nineveh, Rehoboth, Calah and Resen are built. It is unclear whether Nimrod built them or Asshur did (see next page). <i>Genesis 10:11-12</i>

Group notes

Across Scripture

Direct references come first. Thematic echoes are study connections, not places where the text names Nimrod.

Old Testament

Genesis 10:8–12	This is the main account.
1 Chronicles 1:10	"And Cush begat Nimrod: he began to be mighty upon the earth."
Micah 5:6	The prophet speaks of "the land of Nimrod," a name for Assyria.
Echoes	Babel in Shinar is where people build a tower to "make us a name" (Genesis 11:1–9). Babylon later becomes the great enemy of God's people (2 Kings 25; Daniel 1–5). Nineveh is the city Jonah is sent to warn (Jonah 1:2).

New Testament

Echoes	"Babylon the great" is a picture of proud human power set against God (Revelation 17–18). God "hath put down the mighty from their seats, and exalted them of low degree" (Luke 1:52).
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For discussion

1. *Observe:* What words does Genesis use to describe Nimrod (Genesis 10:8–10)?
2. *Understand:* Why do you think Scripture tracks cities like Babel and Nineveh from their very beginning?
3. *Apply:* Nimrod became a byword for strength and fame. What do you most want to be known for?
4. *Apply:* Where are you tempted to trust human power, whether your own or someone else's, more than God?